The Medicaid Crisis Planning Checklist

What to summarize, gather and ask now that Mom needs long-term care.

Mom needs long-term care now, and you're handling care decisions, money questions and paperwork in the same week. Before anyone builds a plan, these are the things to have in hand. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is something still to pull together or ask, not a verdict on Mom or on your family.

Summarize

- [ ] Mom's care situation today, in a few lines: where she is, what help she gets, and what the facility has told you.
- [ ] Her finances as you understand them, in a few lines: what comes in each month, what she owns, and what her care is costing. Round numbers are fine.
- [ ] What you've learned or been told about Medicaid for Mom so far, with who said each thing.
- [ ] The advice you've been given, side by side: the facility, friends, professionals, what you've read. Where two of them disagree, mark it and leave it.

Gather

- [ ] The documents you already have, in one place.
- [ ] A list of the documents that still need to be collected.
- [ ] A plain list of the decisions in front of the family, in any order.
- [ ] A name beside each job on this page: who is writing, who is collecting, who is making which call.

Ask

- [ ] Which decisions on your list need an elder law attorney's review before anyone acts on them.
- [ ] Which decisions need a licensed financial or insurance professional to look at them.
- [ ] Which issues need attention now and which can wait. That is a question to bring to your Medicaid planner, not one to settle at home.
- [ ] What to ask your Medicaid planner or an applications specialist about the timing of an application.
- [ ] Who should be at the table when a plan is reviewed: which family members, and which professionals.

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you summarize, gather and ask. It doesn't say what comes first, what any item means for Medicaid, or what your family should decide. Those belong to the planning conversation, with a professional who knows your state's rules. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've pulled together what you know and lined up what to ask. The planning interview asks about Mom's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for her care.

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